Assignment 1 - FastNotes

IKT205-G 26V Applikasjons Utvikling

Written by:

Arian Mortensen

University of Agder, 2026

Faculty of Engineering and Science
Department of Information and Communication Technology

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1 Introduction

This report compares two frameworks used to build FastNotes, a simple personal note-taking app. The two frameworks evaluated are React Native (Expo) and Native Android with Kotlin and Jetpack Compose.

2 Expirience

Development started with React Native using Expo. Despite having no prior experience with React or JavaScript, the setup process was quick and straightforward. Expo handles a lot of the configuration automatically, which meant less time spent on tooling and more time writing actual app logic. The component-based structure felt intuitive, and hot reload made it easy to see changes instantly. Kotlin with Jetpack Compose required more initial setup, including configuring Android Studio, waiting for Gradle to sync, and understanding the project structure. However, once the project was up and running, Jetpack Compose felt surprisingly similar to React in how UI is built declaratively. The main challenge encountered was keyboard handling, though this was resolved using imePadding. Overall, the experience was smooth.

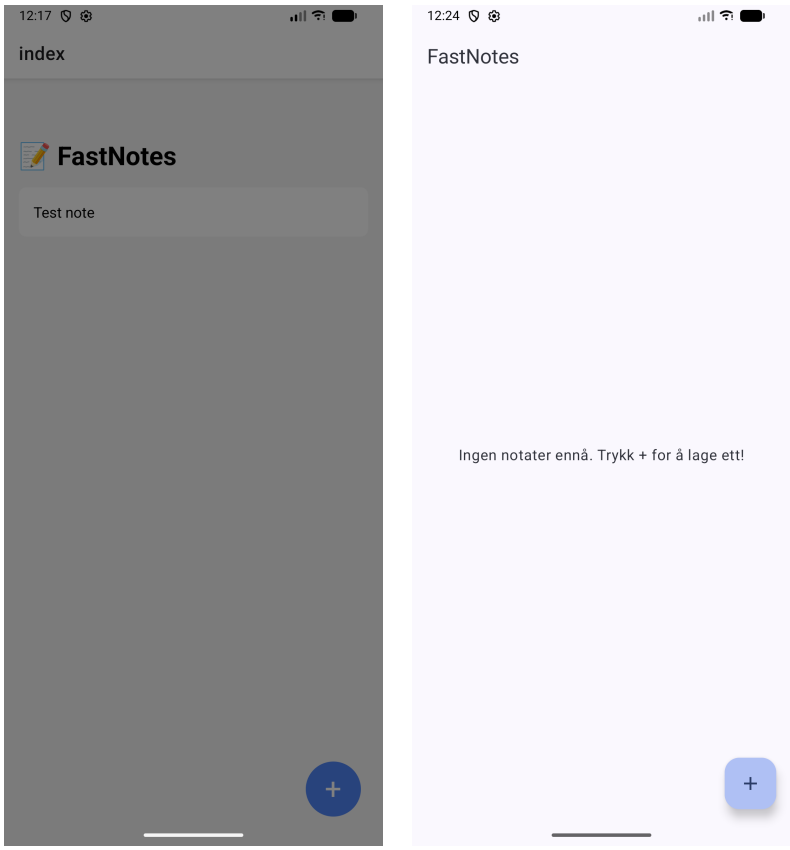

Figure 1: Home pages

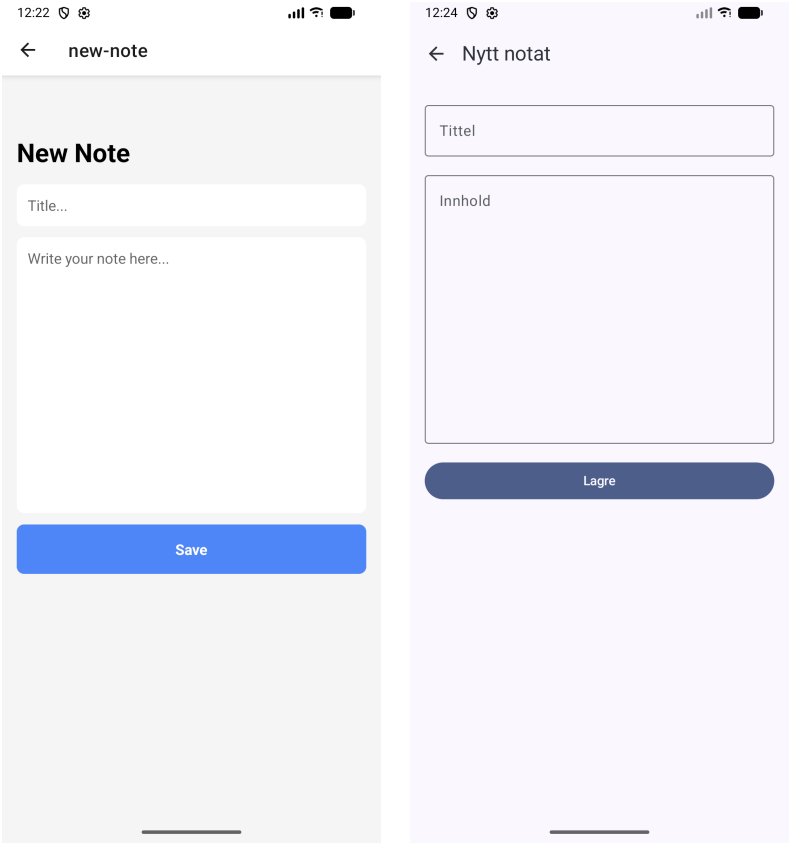

Figure 2: New Note pages

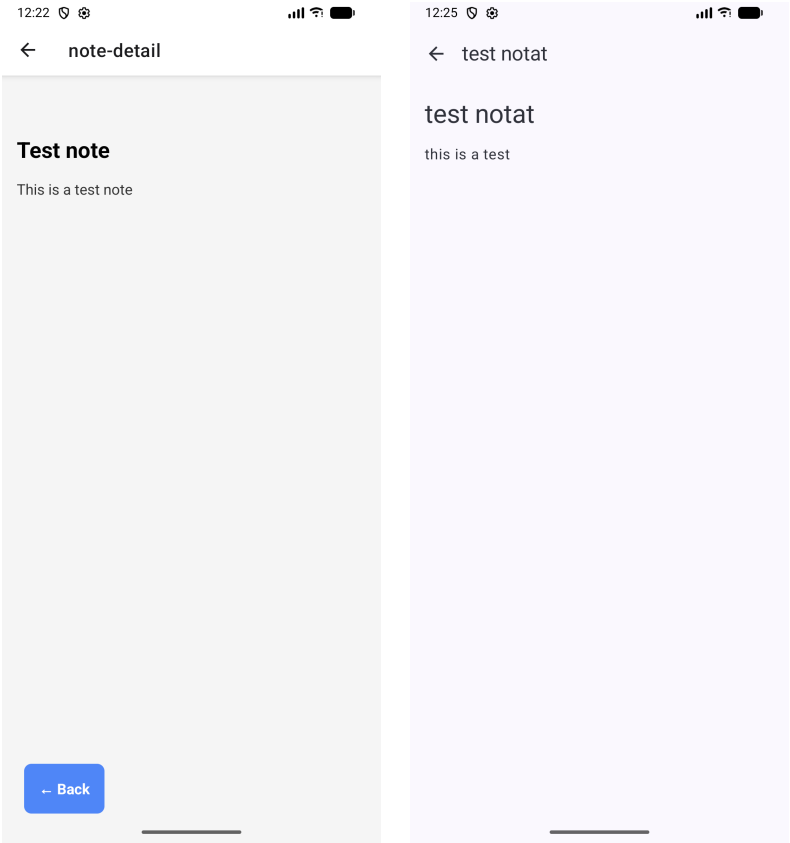

Figure 3: Note detail pages

3 Reflection

Both frameworks proved capable of delivering the required functionality. React Native offers a faster development experience and cross-platform support, making it attractive for teams who want to target both Android and iOS. However, since Blodroed Consulting has plans to expand the app with native functionality, Native Android with Kotlin is the stronger long-term choice. It provides full access to all Android platform features and delivers the best possible performance.